

MUSCLE AND TENDON DISORDERS

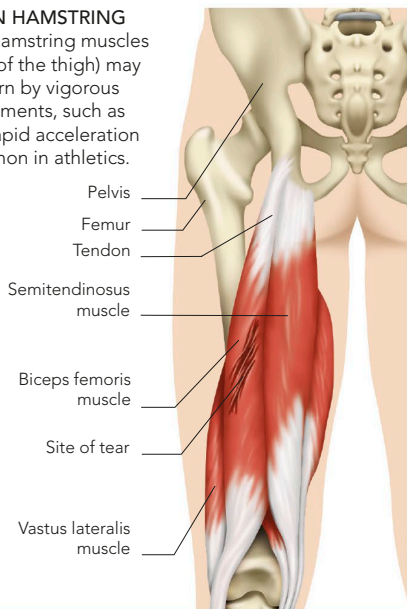
MUSCLES AND TENDONS MAY BE DAMAGED AS A RESULT OF PHYSICAL EXERTION DURING DAILY ACTIVITIES, FROM SUDDEN PULLING OR TWISTING MOVEMENTS SUCH AS THOSE OCCURRING IN SPORT OR AN ACCIDENT, OR FROM REPETITIVE ACTIONS, FOR EXAMPLE, DUE TO EMPLOYMENT.

MUSCLE STRAINS AND TEARS

Muscle strain is the term used for a moderate amount of soft-tissue damage to muscle fibres, which is usually caused by sudden, strenuous movements. Limited bleeding inside the muscle causes tenderness and swelling, which may be accompanied by painful spasms or contractions. Visible bruising may follow. More serious damage, involving a larger number of torn or ruptured fibres, is called a muscle tear. A torn muscle produces severe pain and swelling. Following a medical check to gauge the severity of the injury, the usual treatment is rest, anti-inflammatory medication, and sometimes physiotherapy. Rarely, surgery may be needed to repair a muscle that has been badly torn.

TORN HAMSTRING

The hamstring muscles (rear of the thigh) may be torn by vigorous movements, such as the rapid acceleration common in athletics.

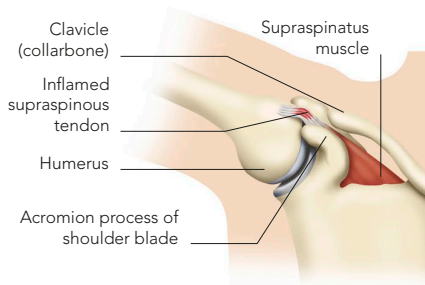


TENDINITIS AND TENOSYNOVITIS

Tendinitis may occur when strong or repeated movement creates excessive friction between the tendon's outer surface and an adjacent bone. Tenosynovitis may be the result of overstretching or repeated movement causing inflammation of the lubricating sheaths that enclose some tendons. Both of these problems can occur together and may be part of the group of disorders known collectively as repetitive strain injuries (RSIs).

TENDINITIS

Repeated arm-lifting, such as in racquet sports, may force the supraspinatus tendon to rub against the shoulder blade's acromion process, causing tendinitis.



TENOSYNOVITIS

The complex, weight-bearing nature of the foot makes it susceptible to tendon damage. Activities such as running, kicking, or dancing may cause inflammation.

